

Day 112 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Economy & TN Dev. Admin. (10): MSP 2026-27 & PM-KISAN Allocation

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Cabinet's MSP approval for Kharif crops (2026-27) and the PM-KISAN scheme's Budget 2026-27 allocation.

Q: Which Cabinet body approved the Minimum Support Price (MSP) increase for 14 Kharif crops for the 2026-27 marketing season, and who chairs it?

A: The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Q: Which crop received the highest absolute MSP increase for 2026-27, and by how much?

A: Sunflower seed — a hike of ₹622 per quintal.

Q: Name the next 3 crops (after sunflower seed) with the largest MSP increases, and their amounts.

A: Cotton (+₹557/quintal), Nigerseed (+₹515/quintal), and Sesamum (+₹500/quintal).

Q: What is the estimated total farmer payout from MSP operations for the 2026-27 Kharif season?

A: Approximately ₹2.60 lakh crore — one of the largest agricultural procurement support mechanisms.

Q: What was PM-KISAN's allocation in the Union Budget 2026-27?

A: ₹63,500 crore.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The MSP increase for 14 Kharif crops (2026-27 season) was approved by:

A. NITI Aayog

B. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) ✓

C. The Reserve Bank of India

D. The Agricultural Costs and Prices Commission alone

Explanation: The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA). [medium, web-research]

2. Which crop received the highest absolute MSP increase for 2026-27 (₹622/quintal)?

A. Cotton

B. Sunflower seed ✓

C. Nigerseed

D. Sesamum

Explanation: Sunflower seed. [medium, web-research]

3. Cotton's MSP increase for 2026-27 was approximately:

A. ₹357/quintal

B. ₹457/quintal

C. ₹557/quintal ✓

D. ₹657/quintal

Explanation: ₹557/quintal. [hard, web-research]

4. The estimated total farmer payout from MSP operations for 2026-27 Kharif crops is approximately:

A. ₹1.60 lakh crore

B. ₹2.10 lakh crore

C. ₹2.60 lakh crore ✓

D. ₹3.10 lakh crore

Explanation: ₹2.60 lakh crore. [hard, web-research]

5. PM-KISAN's allocation in the Union Budget 2026-27 was:

A. ₹43,500 crore

B. ₹53,500 crore

C. ₹63,500 crore ✓

D. ₹73,500 crore

Explanation: ₹63,500 crore. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Number Series

READING MATERIAL

Number Series is the final Reasoning skill. Real exam evidence shows 6 distinct underlying patterns: second-difference (difference-of-differences) sequences, sum-of-consecutive-cubes, geometric progression, arithmetic progression, n^2 multiples, and prime-number-squared sequences — recognize the pattern TYPE before trying to compute term-by-term.

Q: Method — sum of consecutive cubes: Find the next term: 9, 35, 91, ?

A: Each term is $n^3 + (n+1)^3$: $1^3 + 2^3 = 1 + 8 = 9$ ✓, $2^3 + 3^3 = 8 + 27 = 35$ ✓, $3^3 + 4^3 = 27 + 64 = 91$ ✓. Next: $4^3 + 5^3 = 64 + 125 = 189$.

Q: Method — second-difference (arithmetic sequence of differences): Fill in the blank: 1, 6, 15, 28, 45, ____, 91.

A: Differences: $6 - 1 = 5$, $15 - 6 = 9$, $28 - 15 = 13$, $45 - 28 = 17$ — these differences themselves increase by 4 each time. Next difference = $17 + 4 = 21$, so the blank = $45 + 21 = 66$. (Check: $91 - 66 = 25 = 21 + 4$ ✓ consistent.)

Q: Method — sequence of squared primes: Find the missing number in the sequence of squared prime numbers: 4 (2^2), 9 (3^2), 25 (5^2), 49 (7^2), ?, 169 (13^2).

A: The base numbers are consecutive primes: 2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13. The missing term corresponds to $11^2 = 121$. (Caution: the original source rendered this sequence with garbled formatting that looked like plain 3-digit numbers rather than squared primes — always re-derive the actual pattern rather than trusting a confusing transcription.)

Q: Method — simple arithmetic progression (AP) with increasing-by-2 differences: Find the next term: 1, 5, 11, 19, 29, ?

A: Differences: 4, 6, 8, 10 — increasing by 2 each time. Next difference = 12, so next term = $29 + 12 = 41$.

Q: Method — geometric progression (GP): Find the 8th term of 2, 6, 18, 54, ...

A: Common ratio = 3 (each term $\times 3$). Terms: 2, 6, 18, 54, 162, 486, 1458, 4374. The 8th term is 4,374.

Q: Method — plain arithmetic progression, nth term formula: Find the 20th term of 7, 10, 13, ...

A: First term = 7, common difference = 3. nth term = $a + (n-1)d = 7 + (19 \times 3) = 7 + 57 = 64$.

Q: Method — multiples of n^2 : Find the missing number: 3, 12, 27, 48, 75, 108, ____.

A: Each term = $3 \times n^2$ for $n=1, 2, 3, \dots$: $3 \times 1 = 3$, $3 \times 4 = 12$, $3 \times 9 = 27$, $3 \times 16 = 48$, $3 \times 25 = 75$, $3 \times 36 = 108$. Next ($n=7$): $3 \times 49 = 147$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the next term: 2, 9, 28, 65, 126, ?

A. 215

B. 217 ✓

C. 219

D. 221

Explanation: Each term is $n^3 + 1$: $1^3 + 1 = 2$, $2^3 + 1 = 9$, $3^3 + 1 = 28$, $4^3 + 1 = 65$, $5^3 + 1 = 126$. Next: $6^3 + 1 = 216 + 1 = 217$. [hard, authored]

2. Fill in the blank: 2, 7, 14, 23, 34, ____, 62.

A. 45

B. 47 ✓

C. 49

D. 51

Explanation: Differences: 5, 7, 9, 11 — increasing by 2. Next difference = 13, so blank = $34 + 13 = 47$. (Check: $62 - 47 = 15 = 13 + 2$, consistent.) [medium, authored]

3. Find the next term: 3, 7, 15, 27, 43, ?

A. 61

B. 63 ✓

C. 65

D. 67

Explanation: Differences: 4, 8, 12, 16 — increasing by 4. Next difference = 20, so next term = $43 + 20 = 63$. [medium, authored]

4. Find the 7th term of the GP: 3, 9, 27, 81, ...

A. 1,458

B. 2,187 ✓

C. 2,287

D. 1,987

Explanation: Common ratio 3: 3,9,27,81,243,729,2187. 7th term = 2,187. [medium, authored]

5. Find the 15th term of the AP: 5, 9, 13, 17, ...

A. 59

B. 61 ✓

C. 63

D. 65

Explanation: $a=5$, $d=4$. 15th term = $5+(14 \times 4) = 5+56 = 61$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the missing number: 2, 8, 18, 32, 50, ____.

A. 62

B. 68

C. 72 ✓

D. 78

Explanation: Each term = $2 \times n^2$: $2 \times 1=2$, $2 \times 4=8$, $2 \times 9=18$, $2 \times 16=32$, $2 \times 25=50$. Next ($n=6$): $2 \times 36=72$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "His First Flight" — Liam O'Flaherty

READING MATERIAL

A short story about a young seagull too afraid to fly from his cliff ledge, alone after his siblings have already flown, who is finally driven to attempt flight by hunger and his mother's coaxing — and discovers joy and confidence once he succeeds.

Q: Who wrote "His First Flight", and what is the story about?

A: Liam O'Flaherty (1896-1984), an Irish novelist and short-story writer. The story follows a young seagull, left alone on a high ledge after his two brothers and one sister have already flown off, who is too afraid to attempt his own first flight.

Q: Why was the young seagull afraid to fly?

A: He was terrified at the thought of his wings being unable to support him over the vast, far-below expanse of sea — not simply a generic fear of heights, but specifically the thought of his wings failing him mid-flight.

Q: How did the young seagull's parents try to get him to fly, and what finally triggered his first flight attempt?

A: His parents largely ignored/left him alone for a day rather than coaxing him directly. It was ultimately his MOTHER's attempt to bring him food (tempting him toward the edge) that finally prompted his first flight.

Q: What happened when the young seagull tried to land on the sea after his first flight, and how did his family react?

A: He discovered, to his relief, that he could float on the water's surface rather than sinking — a moment of fear giving way to a new, safe discovery. His family then praised him and offered him food, celebrating his success.

Q: What emotion did the young seagull feel once he successfully completed his first flight?

A: Joy — despite his initial terror, his first successful flight left him fearless, exhilarated, and confident, flapping his wings to soar with a joyous scream.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "His First Flight" is a lesson about a:

- A. Pilot
- B. Seagull ✓**
- C. Parrot
- D. Pigeon

Explanation: Seagull. [easy, question-bank-2022]

2. "His First Flight" was written by:

- A. James Grover Thurber
- B. Liam O'Flaherty ✓**
- C. Ruskin Bond
- D. Munshi Premchand

Explanation: Liam O'Flaherty. [easy, web-research]

3. Why was the young seagull afraid to fly?

- A. He had never seen anyone else fly
- B. He thought his wings would not support him ✓**
- C. He did not want to leave his ledge
- D. He was scared of other birds

Explanation: He thought his wings would not support him (fear of unsupported wings). [medium, web-research]

4. How did the young seagull's parents try to encourage him to fly?

- A. They ignored him for a day ✓**
- B. They brought him food every hour
- C. They offered him rewards
- D. They flew away and left him alone permanently

Explanation: They ignored him for a day. [medium, web-research]

5. What finally prompted the young seagull to make his first flight?

- A. His mother's attempt to bring food ✓**

- B. The sight of his siblings flying
- C. His father's scolding
- D. Fear of being left behind

Explanation: His mother's attempt to bring food. [medium, web-research]

6. What emotion did the young seagull feel after his first successful flight?

- A. Fear
- B. Confusion
- C. Joy ✓**
- D. Anger

Explanation: Joy. [easy, web-research]

7. What happened when the young seagull tried to land on the sea?

- A. He immediately drowned
- B. He found he could float on the water ✓**
- C. He got scared and flew back to the ledge
- D. He was pulled under by the current

Explanation: He found he could float on the water. [medium, web-research]

8. How did the seagull's family react to his first flight?

- A. They ignored him
- B. They scolded him for being late
- C. They praised him and offered him food ✓**
- D. They left him alone on the cliff

Explanation: They praised him and offered him food. [easy, web-research]